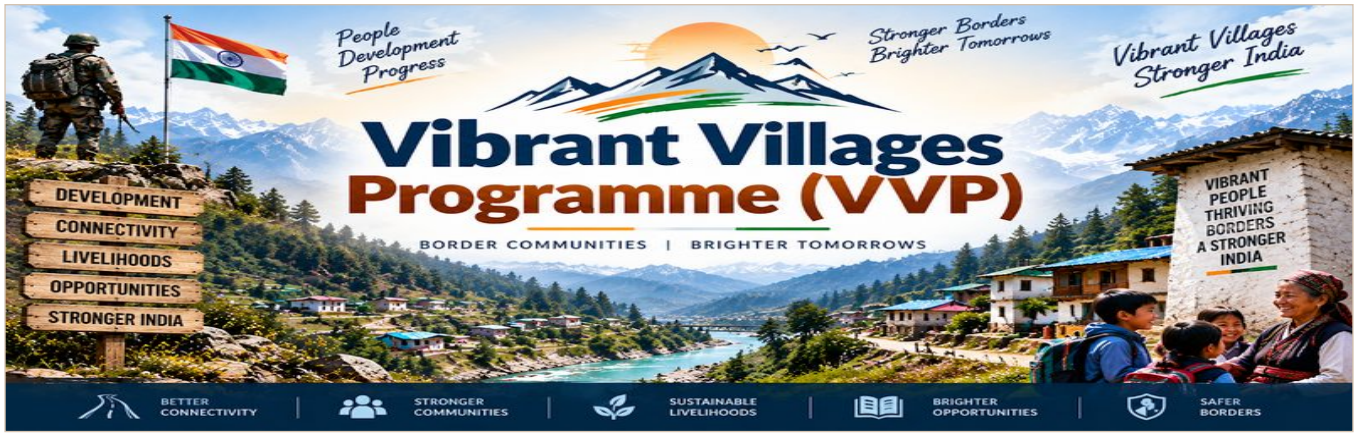


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[GS I - GEOGRAPHY | GS III - INTERNAL SECURITY] | Publication Date: 07/09/2026

Vibrant Villages Programme (VVP)

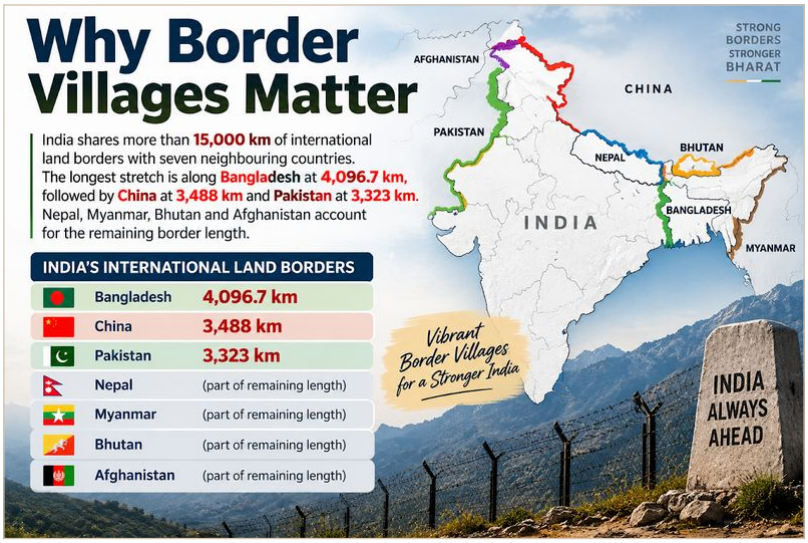


Explore how the Vibrant Villages Programme transforms India's border communities through development, connectivity, livelihoods, tourism, governance and strategic security, strengthening resilient frontiers.

Syllabus Areas:

GS I - Geography | GS III - Internal Security

The **Vibrant Villages Programme (VVP)** is a strategic development initiative aimed at transforming India's border villages into **vibrant, resilient and prosperous communities**. The programme goes beyond conventional infrastructure development by linking **border development with national security, livelihoods, connectivity, governance and community participation**. It is being implemented through **VVP-I and VVP-II**, with a combined financial outlay of **Rs. 11,639 crore**.



Historically, many border villages faced:

- Difficult terrain
- Poor connectivity
- Limited infrastructure
- Inadequate livelihood opportunities

- Restricted access to healthcare and education
- Out-migration due to limited economic opportunities

This resulted in several frontier areas becoming sparsely populated.

The VVP seeks to address these structural challenges by accelerating **comprehensive development in strategically important border villages**. Importantly, the programme changes the perception of these settlements—from being viewed as remote or peripheral areas to being treated as **"the nation's first" villages**.

The programme recognises border residents as the **"eyes and ears" of the border**, making thriving local communities an important component of national security.

Strategic significance

The importance of border communities is illustrated by the **1999 Kargil intrusion**, when local residents were the first to report suspicious movements in the Kargil sector on 3 May 1999. This highlights how an alert and well-connected border population can contribute to the country's security.

Two Phases of the Vibrant Villages Programme

The programme is being implemented in **two phases** to progressively cover India's international land borders.

Vibrant Villages Programme: VVP-I vs VVP-II

Feature	VVP-I	VVP-II
Nature	Centrally Sponsored Scheme	Central Sector Scheme
Funding	Centre + States	100% Centre-funded
Focus	Northern border	Other international land borders
Villages	662	1,954
Financial outlay	₹4,800 crore	₹6,839 crore
Period	2022-23 to 2026-27	2024-25 to 2028-29
Total programme	-	**2,616+ villages / ₹11,639 crore combined**

The two phases share a common objective: **improving living conditions, generating local livelihoods and empowering border communities**, thereby making border villages vibrant centres of development and strengthening national security.

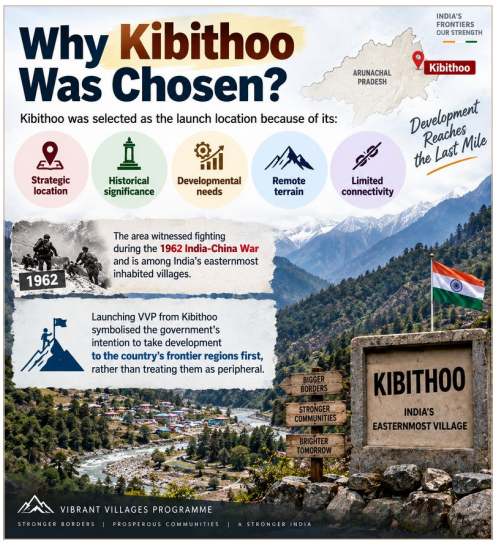
VVP-I: Strengthening Northern Border Communities

- **Announced:** Union Budget 2022-23; launched at **Kibithoo, Arunachal Pradesh, on 10 April 2023**.
- **Coverage: 662 strategic villages** across Arunachal Pradesh, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Sikkim and Ladakh, covering about **1.42 lakh people**.
- **Village-wise:** Arunachal Pradesh – 455; Himachal Pradesh – 75; Uttarakhand – 51; Sikkim – 46; Ladakh – 35.
- **Outlay: Rs. 4,800 crore (2022-23 to 2026-27)**, including **Rs. 2,500 crore for roads**.

Major Interventions

Roads & connectivity • Drinking water • Electricity • Telecom • Healthcare • Education • Tourism • Livelihoods • Financial inclusion • Skill development • Women & youth empowerment • SHGs, cooperatives & FPOs • Local culture • One-Block-One-Product • Social entrepreneurship

The programme follows a **hub-and-spoke livelihood model** and promotes **convergence of government schemes** for comprehensive border development.



VVP-II: Extending the Model to All Land Borders

- **Approved:** 2 April 2025; launched on **20 February 2026** at Nathonpur, Assam.
- **Nature: Central Sector Scheme**, 100% Union Government-funded and implemented by the **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)**.
- **Outlay: Rs. 6,839 crore (2024-25 to 2028-29)**.
- **Coverage: 1,954 villages in 334 blocks** across **15 States and 2 UTs**.
- Covers international land borders other than northern-border villages already covered under VVP-I.

Key Interventions

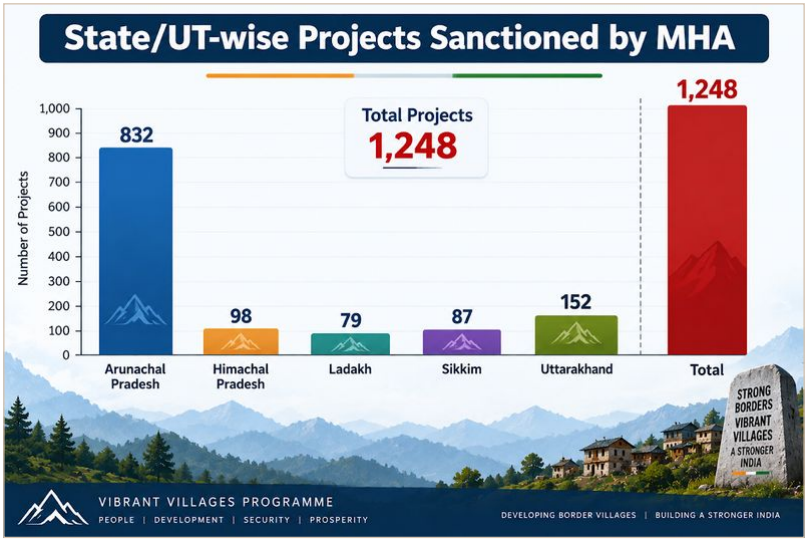
Infrastructure • Roads • Healthcare • Financial inclusion • Skill development • Telecom • Tourism • Sustainable livelihoods • Cooperatives • SHGs • Local value chains • SMART classrooms

Four Key Connectivity Areas

All-weather roads • Television connectivity • Telecom connectivity • On-grid electrification

Core objective: Improve living conditions, create livelihoods and encourage people to **stay in border villages**, thereby strengthening resilient frontier communities.





Road Connectivity and Long-Span Bridges

Connectivity is a major pillar of the programme because geographical isolation is one of the biggest constraints faced by remote border settlements.

Under VVP-I:

- **111 road projects** were sanctioned.
- These projects have an outlay of **Rs. 2,481.93 crore**.
- They will connect **134 villages** that previously lacked road connectivity.
- **35 long-span bridges** were also sanctioned.

Improved roads are expected to:

- Reduce travel difficulties
- Connect villages with markets
- Improve access to essential services
- Support tourism
- Strengthen overall integration of remote villages with the wider economy





Youth Engagement: Viksit Vibrant Village Programme

In 2026, the **Viksit Vibrant Village Programme** engaged **400+ volunteers from all States and UTs** across **74 border villages** in Ladakh, Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand. Volunteers contributed through **community service, cultural exchange and grassroots development**, helping youth understand India's frontier regions while supporting local communities and development.

VVP's Impact Beyond Infrastructure

A. Security

Strong, populated and economically viable border communities support border forces while creating frontier populations that serve as strategic national assets.

B. Demography & Reverse Migration

Better connectivity and livelihoods encourage families to remain or return, helping reduce out-migration and demographic vulnerability in remote frontier areas.

C. Local Economy

Tourism, cooperatives, SHGs, FPOs and local enterprises create sustainable local incomes, while border-force procurement provides nearby markets for village producers.

D. Governance

Scheme convergence and Village Action Plans help eligible households access government schemes while enabling district administrations to coordinate departmental interventions.

Border Development as a Security Strategy

VVP links development with security: better services reduce migration, strengthen populations, expand local economies, build resilience and support border security.

The **Vibrant Villages Programme** transforms border settlements into partners in **development and national security**. Through infrastructure, connectivity, livelihoods, tourism, healthcare, education and scheme convergence, it promotes **prosperous, resilient communities**, strengthens India's borders, and advances the vision of a **secure, inclusive Viksit Bharat by 2047**.

Also Read: Districts as Export Hubs